



"What is AI?" — A 50-Minute Introduction

Audience: Higher-ed staff & students **Duration:** 50 minutes **Format:** Workshop / seminar

Learning objectives

By the end, participants can:

- Explain, in plain language, what Generative AI, LLMs, Multimodal models, RAG, and AI agents are.
- Describe how each works and where it gets its answers.
- Evaluate an AI output for bias and factual accuracy.
- Identify at least one responsible classroom or workplace application.

Materials

- Projector or shared screen with the *What is AI* page (inspiredbi.org/what-is-ai.html) and its five videos.
- The one-page *5 Concepts* cheat sheet (one per participant).
- Device access for the paired activity; an institution-approved AI tool.

Agenda

0-5 min	Hook Ask: "How many of you used an AI tool this week? Do you know how it actually works?" Surface assumptions and set the goal — understand the inner workings, not just the buttons.
5-30 min	The five concepts Walk through GenAI, LLMs, Multimodal, RAG, and Agentic AI (5 min each) using the plain-language explanations and the short video for each on the What is AI page.
30-42 min	Activity — Bias & verification audit In pairs, run the same prompt through an AI tool. Ask: Who is missing? Whose perspective dominates? Then fact-check one claim against a primary source.
42-50 min	Application & exit ticket Each participant names one concept they'll apply this term and one guardrail (data privacy, verification, or citation). Collect exit tickets.

Assessment

Exit ticket — one concept to apply + one guardrail — serves as a quick formative check. Optional follow-up: participants draft a two-sentence AI-use note for a syllabus or team norm.

Extensions

Staff: redesign one assignment to state where AI is encouraged, permitted with citation, or off-limits.
Students: build a verification checklist for AI-generated content.